

API2Test — Quick Start Guide

Import APIs · Build libraries · Generate tests — inside VS Code

API2Test imports your API definitions (Postman collections or OpenAPI/Swagger specs), organizes them into reusable libraries, and helps you generate API test classes — all inside VS Code. This guide gets you from install to your first generated test in minutes.

1. Install

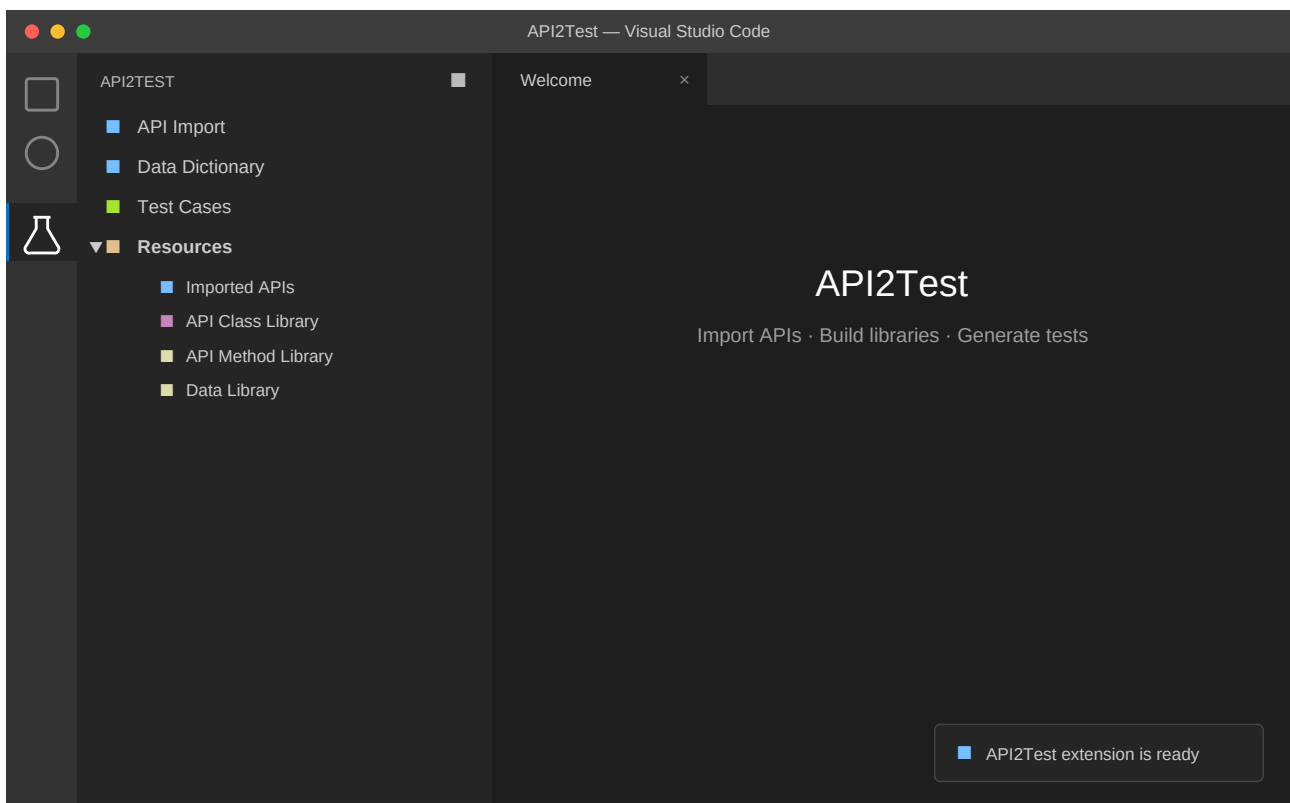
Install the bundled extension package **Api2Test.vsix**:

```
code --install-extension Api2Test.vsix
```

Or in VS Code: Extensions view (Ctrl+Shift+X) → “...” menu → **Install from VSIX...** → pick Api2Test.vsix. When it activates you'll see “**API2Test extension is ready**”. See [InstallationGuide.pdf](#) for full steps.

2. Open the API2Test panel

Click the **flask icon** in the Activity Bar. The API2Test tree view opens with four entries: API Import, Data Dictionary, Test Cases and Resources.



Entry	What it does
API Import	Import a Postman collection or OpenAPI/Swagger spec
Data Dictionary	Define and manage field-level test data
Test Cases	View and generate API test cases

3. Import an API

Click **API Import** and choose a source. The format is detected automatically, then you pick the application the endpoints belong to.

- **From File** — a .json Postman collection or an OpenAPI/Swagger (.json / .yaml) file.
- **From URL** — a link to a hosted OpenAPI/Swagger spec.

Import API

Postman collections and OpenAPI / Swagger specs are detected automatically.

Import from File
Choose a .json / .yaml collection or spec
petstore-openapi.json
Import File

Import from URL
Paste a link to a hosted OpenAPI spec
https://petstore3.swagger.io/api/v3/openapi.json
Import URL

Step 2 — Select an application
After choosing a source you'll be asked which application the endpoints belong to.
PetStore▼

Try it with the samples in the **Example Swagger Files** folder, then verify the result under **Resources** → **Imported APIs**.

4. Review your libraries (Resources)

- **Imported APIs** — every endpoint you've imported, in a table view.
- **API Class Library** — the API client classes available for generation.
- **API Method Library** — individual API methods (add / edit / delete).
- **Data Library** — reusable data-generation methods (add / edit / delete).

5. Set up your Data Dictionary

Open **Data Dictionary** to define the fields your tests use — name, type, whether they're mandatory, and which data method supplies their value. Use **Import Data Dictionary from API Endpoints** to bootstrap it from imported endpoints.

Data Dictionary
×

Data Dictionary
+ Add Field
Import...

Field Name	Type	Mandatory	Data Method	Actions
petId	integer	Yes	GenerateRandomId()	edit delete
name	string	Yes	RandomName()	edit delete
status	string	No	PickFrom("available","sold")	edit delete
category	object	No	DefaultCategory()	edit delete
quantity	integer	Yes	RandomInt(1,100)	edit delete

5 fields · derived from imported PetStore endpoints

6. Generate a test

Open **Test Cases** and click **Generate Test**, or right-click an endpoint to **Generate Class**. The generators combine your endpoints, libraries and data dictionary into ready-to-use API test classes — see the Example Generated Project.

Test Cases
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Test Cases
Generate Test

Test Name	Method	Endpoint	Application	Status
AddPet_ReturnsCreated	POST	/pet	PetStore	✓ ready
GetPetById_ReturnsOk	GET	/pet/{petId}	PetStore	✓ ready
UpdatePet_ReturnsOk	PUT	/pet	PetStore	✓ ready
DeletePet_ReturnsOk	DELETE	/pet/{petId}	PetStore	draft
FindByStatus_ReturnsList	GET	/pet/findByStatus	PetStore	✓ ready

Generated test classes are written to your project and tracked in api-tests.json.

Where your data lives

All API2Test data is stored as JSON at `~/.vscode/API2Test/data/` (Windows: `C:\Users\<you>\.vscode\API2Test\data\`). Files are created on first run and never overwritten, so your edits are safe across updates.

Troubleshooting

- **Tree empty after import** — click Refresh at the top of the panel.

- **Import from URL fails** — ensure the URL returns the raw spec (JSON/YAML), not an HTML page.
- **Extension didn't activate** — check Output → API2Test for the activation log.

When you've finished trying API2Test, please complete the Feedback Questionnaire. Thank you!